Xin YAN

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PROFILE

- Chinese language teacher and applied linguist. MA in Teaching Chinese to Speakers of Other Languages, Peking University (ranked 1st of 31); Cambridge PhD in Chinese linguistics and language acquisition (thesis submitted September 2026).
- Over 2,000 hours of language teaching since 2015, including Chinese modules at the University of Cambridge and three years teaching Chinese at Kharkiv National University (Ukraine). Experienced in curriculum design from beginner to upper-intermediate level, HSK preparation, and online and technology-enhanced teaching.

EDUCATION

University of Cambridge (UK), Faculty of Asian and Middle Eastern Studies 2022 - present
PhD (Chinese Linguistics and Language Acquisition)
- Thesis (submitted September 2026): *Anchoring Entities and Events in Monolingual, Bidialectal, and Bilingual Speakers' Mandarin Chinese*
- Fully funded by the UKRI Open-Oxford-Cambridge AHRC DTP Studentship

Peking University (China), School of Chinese as a Second Language 2019 - 2022
Master of Teaching Chinese to Speakers of Other Languages
- GPA 3.8/4, ranked 1st of 31; National Scholarship (2020); Excellent Graduate (2022)

Anhui University (China), School of Foreign Studies 2011 - 2015
BA in Russian Language and Literature

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

University of Cambridge (UK), Faculty of Asian and Middle Eastern Studies 2022 - 2026
Interim Lecturer in Modern Chinese (part-time)
- Teach four undergraduate modules: Chinese Text and Practice; Chinese Oral; Chinese Aural; Interpreting
- Develop syllabi, teaching materials and classroom activities
- Contribute to Modern Chinese teaching team meetings and collaborative course development

Undergraduate Supervisor in Modern Chinese (part-time)
- Delivered 200+ hours of small-group supervisions (1–2 students) in Modern Chinese
- Give individual feedback on written and oral work and monitor each student's progress

Peking University (China), Yenching Academy and Pre-University Programme 2019 - 2022
Teaching Assistant in Chinese (part-time)
- Supported Chinese language teaching for international master's students, including one-to-one tutoring
- Assisted classroom teaching and tracked the progress of international pre-university students

Readboy Education Technology, HKG: 2385 (China) 2019 - 2022
English Language Instructor, live online courses (part-time)
- Designed and taught 300 hours of live-streamed lessons, with 500,000+ cumulative learner participations
- Developed courseware, teaching materials and interactive online activities
- Used platform data and learner feedback to identify content gaps, informing 10+ new courses

V. N. Karazin Kharkiv National University (Ukraine) 2015 - 2018
Chinese Language Teacher
- Taught 1,600 hours on university courses and public courses for learners from teenagers to adults
- Designed Chinese curricula from beginner to upper-intermediate level
- Taught HSK preparation courses and helped to run and invigilate HSK examinations in eastern Ukraine
- Awarded the Vice-Rector's Commendation for teaching excellence

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

University of Cambridge (UK) 2022 - 2026

Doctoral Researcher (supervisor: Dr Lucy Xia Zhao)

- Compared how Mandarin monolingual, Cantonese–Mandarin bidialectal and Russian–Mandarin bilingual speakers use function words to anchor entities and events in discourse
- Tested 300+ participants across the UK, China and Russia; 600+ hours of one-to-one data collection
- Built the experimental platform in JsPsych; modelled 35,000+ observations in R

Peking University (China) 2019 - 2022

Graduate Researcher (supervisor: Dr Shanshan Yan)

- Studied how Russian-speaking learners of Chinese use syntactic and prosodic cues to resolve wh-ambiguity
- Studied the acquisition of the Chinese conjunction *hé* by Russian-speaking learners

PUBLICATIONS

In preparation	**Yan, X.**, & Yan, S. Ambiguity resolution of wh-complexes by Russian-speaking L2 learners of Chinese: The roles of syntactic and prosodic cues, and sensitivity to lexical contrasts. Journal article.
In preparation	Alexopoulou, D., Cheng, Y., Wei, Z., **Yan, X.**, & Zhou, M. (Eds.). *Proceedings of the 18th Generative Approaches to Second Language Acquisition Conference (GASLA 18)*. Edited volume.
2025	**Yan, X.**, & Yan, S. Interfaces in ambiguity resolution of wh-elements by L1-Russian L2-Chinese speakers: A case study of the *na*-construction ("which-construction"). In *Proceedings of the 49th Annual Boston University Conference on Language Development (BUCLD 49)*. Cascadilla Press.
2020	**Yan, X.**, Peng, L., & Yan, S. L1 Russian L2 Chinese speakers' acquisition of the Chinese conjunction *hé*. In *Proceedings of the 11th International Conference of Experimental Linguistics (ExLing 2020)*.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

2026	**Yan, X.**, Tsimpli, I. M., & Zhao, L. X. Referential anchoring in monodialectal and bidialectal Mandarin. Poster, *GASLA 18*, University of Cambridge, UK.
2024	**Yan, X.**, & Yan, S. Interfaces in ambiguity resolution of wh-elements by L1-Russian L2-Chinese speakers. Talk, *BUCLD 49*, Boston University, USA.
2024	**Yan, X.**, & Yan, S. Ambiguity resolution of wh-elements at interfaces in L2 Chinese: Comparing the role of prosody and syntax. Talk, *GALA 16*, Lisbon, Portugal.
2021	**Yan, X.**, Peng, L., & Yan, S. The acquisition of Chinese functional words by Russian speakers: The case of the conjunction *hé*. Poster, *YLMP 2021*, Poznań, Poland.
2020	**Yan, X.**, Peng, L., & Yan, S. L1 Russian L2 Chinese speakers' acquisition of the Chinese conjunction *hé*. Talk, *ExLing 2020*, Athens, Greece.
2018	**Yan, X.** The occurrence of the auxiliary word *zài* in Mandarin Chinese. Talk, *2nd Annual Conference on Orientalism in Ukraine*, Kharkiv, Ukraine.

ACADEMIC SERVICE AND COORDINATION

2025 - present	**Organising Committee Member, GASLA 18**, University of Cambridge (April 2026): coordinated the review of 150+ submissions and logistics for 150+ attendees; now co-editing the proceedings
2023 - 2024	**Coordinator**, Chinese Linguistics Seminar, Faculty of Asian and Middle Eastern Studies, University of Cambridge: ran 10+ seminars
2020 - 2022	**Founder and Organiser**, *Statistics with R* workshop and *Language & Mind* reading group, Peking University: 30+ cross-institutional sessions

AWARDS AND FUNDING

2022 - 2026	UKRI Open-Oxford-Cambridge AHRC DTP Studentship (full award) *Arts and Humanities Research Council, UK Research and Innovation*
2024 - 2025	Faculty Fieldwork Funding (AMES) and College Research Grants (Homerton College) *University of Cambridge*
2024	Paula Menyuk Award *Boston University Conference on Language Development*
2020 - 2022	Triple-A Student (2020, 2021); Innovation Award in Scientific Practice (2021); Excellent Graduate (2022) *Peking University*
2020	National Scholarship *Ministry of Education, China*
2015 - 2018	Vice-Rector's Commendation for teaching excellence *Kharkiv National University*

TEACHING QUALIFICATIONS

2019	Certificate for Teachers of Chinese to Speakers of Other Languages ID T201950101509
2022	Senior High School Teacher Qualification Certificate (Chinese), PRC ID 20223450141001585
2021	Senior High School Teacher Qualification Certificate (English), PRC ID 20211100141011823
2014	Putonghua Proficiency Test Certificate, Level 2-A, PRC ID 3434212004100

SKILLS AND LANGUAGES

Digital skills	R (statistical analysis); jsPsych (online experiments); AI tools for lesson preparation, feedback and assessment design; live-streaming teaching platforms
Research	Experimental design, questionnaire design, statistical modelling, data visualisation
Languages	Mandarin Chinese (native); English (fluent, IELTS 8.0); Russian (degree level)

Updated: 14th Oct 2026